

5.1 Browsing

Viewing Web pages is termed *browsing*, and you require a software called a *browser* to do this. Windows XP comes with an inbuilt browser called Internet Explorer (IE). IE does what its name says—it lets you explore

the Internet and acts as your window to the connected world. Currently in version 6, Internet Explorer includes new and enhanced features that simplify daily tasks while maintaining the privacy of your personal information on the Web.



Microsoft Internet Explorer—the browser integrated with Windows XP

Some of the key features offered by the latest version of Internet Explorer are:

Image Toolbar: When you move your mouse pointer over images on Web pages, the Image Toolbar appears giving instant access to various functions related to pictures. You can quickly save, e-mail, and print your pictures from a Web page, and also view all your saved pictures in the 'My Pictures' folder.

Media Bar: Provides a user interface for locating and playing media within the browser window. You can play music, video, or mixed-media files without opening a separate window. You can also control the audio volume, choose which media files or tracks to play, and access different media on your computer.

Auto Image Resize: Resizes pictures that are too large to display in the browser window so they fit within the dimensions of the window.

Favorites: Put Web sites you visit often within easy reach. That way, you don't have to remember or type anything. Just click your mouse twice, and there you are! As your list of favourite pages grows, you can organise them by moving them into subfolders.